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NAVIGATOR

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the Residents of The Peninsula



Making a Difference –

By Keri Mrazum

Maggie Farrell and the
Carolina Raptor Center

Volunteering your time is an integral part of society. Maggie Farrell is an example of a person who volunteers simply because she cares. After various volunteering efforts, Maggie found her passion in the Carolina Raptor Center.

Maggie Farrell lives in the Peninsula with her husband John, and their three children. They moved to the Peninsula in 1995, after a job offer in the area. John and Maggie's three children are all currently attending college. Kelly is a graduate student in biology and ecology at Oregon State University, Katie is a graduate student also in biology and ecology at Appalachian State University, and Bryan is a junior majoring in Chinese and Linguistics at University of Carolina at Chapel Hill. Volunteering has always been important to Maggie as she has volunteered with a number of organizations since moving to Cornelius, including 12 years at various local schools (Cornelius Elem., Caburus Academy/Cannon School, Alexander Middle, Davidson IB Middle, North Meck HS).

Maggie was transporting her daughter to the Carolina Raptor Center to volunteer in the resident bird care and docent programs, as part of the requirements at North Mecklenburg High School. As a result, Maggie spent a good deal of time at the Carolina Raptor Center, and realized that she wanted to volunteer as well.

Maggie volunteered her time in the Rehabilitation Department at the Carolina Raptor Center (CRC). Maggie assists with getting the injured birds ready to be released back into the wild. She also does bird rescues and transportation when CRC receives local calls of injured raptors. You've probably seen Maggie in hiking boots and CRC shirt, tramping along the highway, in a field, or in a tree, searching for, or chasing down an injured bird. During her time in the Rehab Dept., Maggie has done everything from sewing wing wrappers used to protect broken wings, cleaning cages, to preparing food and medica-



Maggie Farrell

tions, weighing, and feeding the injured birds. Maggie has also learned to treat wounds, and bandage injured areas, as well as taking and reading blood samples. "It's very rewarding when you are assisting the vet with physical therapy and surgery, and coping (trimming) beaks and talons," explains Maggie.

Maggie has also been checking-in injured birds brought to the center by other volunteers or the public. Usually her shift is Thursday mornings, and she claims "my friends know not to plan anything involving me on Thursdays!" She can be found at the center for three to seven hours depending on the time of year and how many calls they receive. One of the most rewarding experiences for Maggie involves an egg rescue. CRC received a call that there was a barred owl nest with two eggs in it and two adult owls living at the worksite. Maggie retrieved the eggs and brought them back to the center in an insulated box. At the center they place the eggs in incubator, and watched

them hatch. When hatched, the babies were placed in a cage with other orphans and a surrogate (resident) barred owl. After the babies were strong enough to be free, Maggie had the privilege of releasing one of her rescued eggs in a rural section of Davidson. Maggie exclaimed "A friend who lives near the release site stills hear the hooting at night. It was a thrill to be part of such an amazing and rewarding process".

If anyone would like more information, go to the Carolina Raptor Center web site, www.carolinaraptorcenter.org, and look under volunteering. There is a schedule of orientation classes and an application form. Or call 704-875-6521.

Do you know someone who volunteers? We want to hear from you.
Please email the Peninsula Navigator at Peninsula@2424.com.